

[Return to Search](#)

Original Page: 114**Culture (OWC):** [San \(FX10\)](#)**Region:** Africa**Sub Region:** Southern Africa**Field Date:** 1973-1975**Coverage Date:** 1973-1975**Place Coverage:** /Ai/Ai And Environs, Northwest Botswana**Section Title(S):** Affinal Xin

To each term is attached a relationship of joking or respect. Essentially one is allowed to joke with everybody in one's own generation except siblings of the opposite sex and their spouses, one's spouse's siblings of the same sex and their spouses as well as everybody in alternate generations to yours. The homonymous method of applying terms again takes precedence over the generational and one has the same joking relationship as the individual for whom one is given a term. The joking relationship is always reciprocal and as soon as one person has a kin term for another, both know within what bounds they must behave. It is a mechanism for releasing tension, and as will be discussed later, is used to level individuals who consider themselves "bigshots."

[601
Kinship Terminology](#)[602
Kin Relationships](#)

Human Relations Area Files

*755 Prospect Street**New Haven, CT 06511*General Inquiries:  hraf@yale.eduIssues and Bugs:  hraf-support@yale.edu[Terms and Conditions](#) · [Accessibility](#) · [Cookie Policy](#)